

Instructions for Administration:

9 Months Old

Note Ensure to wash your hands before handling the child and to handle the child gently.

Definitions

Plane: In reference to items requiring holding a body part on the same plane as another, this refers to being level to.

Prone Position: The prone position refers to lying horizontally with the face and torso facing down. The infant lies with knees drawn up under the abdomen with pelvis high. Head is turned to one side.

Supine Position: The supine position refers to lying horizontally with the face and torso facing up.

Ventral Suspension: The baby is placed in prone position and suspended in the air by a hand placed under the chest. The head hangs down with some flexion of elbows and knees.

1.1 Gross Motor

Notes If the child does not perform the gross motor item for their age, but performs a more advanced gross motor item, then the item specific for their age is considered normal.

1.1.26	a) Tries to creep, after rolling from supine to prone position OR b) Progresses by rolling without any difficulty	Age: 9 months
1.1.26a	Tries to creep, after rolling from supine to prone position	Age: 9 months
Materials	Attractive Toy, Padded Surface	
Overview	Movement involving both arms and legs, and with the trunk on the floor, is known as creeping and it usually occurs before crawling.	
Instructions	Place the infant in supine position on a padded surface on the floor. Show a toy to attract and encourage the infant to roll from supine to prone. Then, put the toy on the floor, in front of the infant but out of reach and encourage them to get it.	
Response	The infant tries to creep forward.	
Grading	Present With some difficulty Only from supine to prone with difficulty Needs assistance	

1.1.26b	Progresses by rolling without any difficulty	Age: 9 months
Materials	Attractive Toy, Padded Surface	
Overview	For most infants, rolling is an early transient form of movement which may occur accidentally or be indulged in for pleasure. It might be used occasionally for the purpose of moving to another point or to reach an object. The limitation of this movement is that it is not possible for the child to look in the direction of movement or at the object they are moving towards all the time, whereas in other forms of movement the infant is able to do so. Some disabled infants have to use this as their only means of movement and its limitations must be kept in mind.	
Instructions	Place the infant in supine position on a padded surface on the floor. Put a toy on the floor to attract the infant so that when the infant reaches for the toy they must progress by rolling.	
Response	Observe the infant's quality of progression by rolling. The rolling must involve supine-to-prone, followed by prone-to-supine, at least once.	
Grading	Present With some difficulty Only from supine to prone with difficulty Needs assistance	

1.1.27	Independent sitting	Age: 9 months
Materials	Padded Surface	
Instructions	Sit the infant on a padded surface on the floor. Give support by placing hands around the infant's lower back. Gradually loosen your hold on the infant and observe if the infant can sit unsupported for a few minutes.	
Response	Observe if the infant can sit unsupported for a few minutes.	
Grading	Present Sits for few seconds unsupported Sits with self support Sits with other's help	

1.1.28	Stands holding on to furniture	Age: 9 months
Materials	Chair or another item of furniture	
Instructions	Hold the infant upright in a supported standing position, placing their hands on a piece of furniture at chest level.	
Response	Observe the infant's ability to keep standing by holding onto the furniture for at least one minute	
Grading	Present Without assistance for <1 minute Without assistance, but momentarily With assistance only	



1.2 Fine Motor Items

Note If the child does not perform the fine motor item for their age, but performs a more advanced fine motor item, then the item specific for their age is considered normal.

1.2.9	Digital grasp of block	Age: 9 - 10 months
Materials	1 Block	
Overview	The digital grasp is when the object is held with opposed thumb and fingertips, with space visible between.	
Instructions	Sit the infant on the caregiver's lap supported upright at a table. Place one block on the table in front of the infant and within their reach.	
Response	Observe if the infant grasps the block using fingers with a gap between the palm and the block.	
Grading	Present Clumsy Digital Grasp Palmar Grasp No Palmar Grasp	

1.3 Vision Items

Notes When smarties or 100s & 1000s are required for Vision items, select colours that contrast with the green cloth.

- Use: Yellow, Orange, Red
- Avoid: Green, Blue, Purple

Near vision and watching adults are evaluated separately, but only near vision is considered for the scoring of domain severity. When scoring vision of the child, fixation on objects placed on the tabletop is considered normal response.

1.3.9	Watches moving adult from 3 metres	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Stand in front of the infant at a distance of three metres and draw their attention. Move along an arc around the visual field of the infant and observe if the eyes move to track the moving adult. If no response, keep coming closer and observe the distance at which the infant's visual attention is engaged.	
Response	Infant watches moving adult from 3 metres.	
Grading	Present From 2m From 1m From <1m	

1.3.12	Fixates on 100 & 1000 from 30cm	Age: 9 - 11 months
Materials	1 100s & 1000s, Green Cloth If no response to 100s & 1000s: Smartie, Yellow Block, Red Ball on String, Compact Mirror, Torch	
Instructions	The infant is seated supported upright in the caregiver's lap at a table, which is covered with a green cloth. Show the 100 & 1000 (a < 3mm sized sweet) to the infant and say "Ooh! Look at this beautiful thing". Place the 100 & 1000 on one side of the table keeping the gaze of the infant on it. Then, sweep your hand across the table holding the 100 & 1000, and release it at some point during the sweep of your hand across the table. Observe whether the infant fixates their gaze on the released object or not. If no response, test with a smartie; then with a 2.5 cm block; then with the 6cm spinning red ball on string; then with a reflecting object; then a torch beam	

	
Response	Infant fixes gaze on the 100 & 1000 from 30cm.
Grading	Present Can see non-reflected object of 1.5cm (e.g., Smartie) Can see non-reflected object of >1.5cm (e.g., 2.5cm block) Perceives bright light or reflecting object

1.4 Hearing Items

Note Soft whisper - 10 to 25 db; conversational speech - 25 to 55 db; crying baby - 55 to 65 db; rattle - 60 to 80db.

1.4.9	Distraction test at ear level - Rattle	Age: 7 - 11 months
Materials	Assistant, Rattle, Any Soundless Toy	
Instructions	The infant is seated on the caregiver's lap, supported upright. The examiner is the 'distractor' who sits in front of the infant at a distance of 1 to 2 metres. The assistant stands behind the caregiver and the child to provide a sound stimulus. The distractor encourages the infant's attention towards themselves by lightly playing with a 'soundless' toy, then swiftly putting it out of sight as a signal to the assistant to start the sound stimulus (rattle) at 1 metre from the ear at the infant's ear level and outside of their range of vision. The test is done in turn on each side of the infant.	
Response	The infant will turn their head and visually locate the source of the sound, equally on both sides.	
Grading	Present Questionable To loud rattle only No response	



1.4.10	Distraction test at ear level - Voice	Age: 7 - 11 months
Materials	Assistant, Any Soundless Toy	
Instructions	The infant is seated on the caregiver's lap, supported upright. The examiner is the 'distractor' who sits in front of the infant at a distance of 1 to 2 metres. The assistant stands behind the caregiver and the child to provide a sound stimulus. The distractor encourages the infant's attention towards themselves by lightly playing with a 'soundless' toy, then swiftly putting it out of sight as a signal to the assistant to start the sound stimulus (voice) at 1 metre from the ear at the infant's ear level and outside of their range of vision. The test is done in turn on each side of the infant.	
Response	The infant will turn their head and visually locate the source of the sound, equally on both sides.	
Grading	Present Questionable To loud voice only No response	



1.5 Expressive Language Item

Note This domain relies primarily on observation of infant vocalisations during the session:

- The examiner has to be vigilant about recording all infant vocalisations during the entire assessment so that none are missed.
- Interact and speak with the child to encourage vocalisations.
- If no vocalisations are made throughout the assessment, ask the caregiver if this is typical as it is not uncommon for young children to behave differently in new and unfamiliar situations. Document specific examples of vocalisations reported by the caregiver on the record form.

1.5.7	Vocalising double sounds e.g, “ma-ma”, “da-da”	Age: 9 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	These are two syllable repetitions. These vocalisations attract attention and are used frequently and effectively to do so. For example, “ma-ma” and “da-da”.	
Response	Note the frequency of these double sounds.	
Grading	Frequent double sounds Seldom Only Vowels No Vowels	

1.6 Cognition Items

1.6.14	Plays imitative games	Age: 9 months
Materials	Spoons, blocks, cup	
Instructions	The examiner demonstrates to the infant a few activities, e.g., banging spoons together, clicking blocks, or rattling a spoon in a cup. If no response, demonstrate at least six times.	
Response	Immediately after the demonstration, the infant should imitate the action.	
Grading	Present After >3 demonstrations After >5 demonstrations No attempt	



1.6.15	Visually tracks falling ball when out of sight	Age: 9 - 10 months
Materials	Plastic ball or Red Woolly Ball	
Instructions	A woollen or soft plastic silent ball of about 7.5-10 cm in diameter is rolled across the table between the examiner's two hands twice, then flicked gently over the outer edge of the table onto the floor out of sight of the infant. If no response, repeat three times, then flick ball within child's range of vision. If completing the assessment on a hard surface, the green cloth may be placed on the floor to silence the sound of the ball falling from the table.	
Response	Observe if the infant searches for the ball.	
Grading	Present Tracks ball only while in sight Partial following (follows ball on the table only) Never	



1.7 Behaviour Items

Note It is essential the examiner scores the Behaviour items based on their observations and caregiver report regarding sleep. Observe and record the child's behaviour according to the activities listed under this domain.

1.7.6	Sleep/awake rhythm	Age: 1 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Ask the caregiver about the infant's sleep patterns.	
Response	Score according to caregiver's recall. Over the first 3 months of life the total amount of sleep declines little, but the cycles are longer so that, by the age of 3 months, 70% of infants are sleeping right through the night. By 6 months, 80% of infants sleep through the night, but there are still 10% waking every night by the age of 1 year. By this age, the great majority of infants have established a stable pattern of sleep and wakefulness with a long sleep at night and a nap in the morning and afternoon. Mild, moderate and severe grades of response are: occasional disturbance, considerable disturbance, and constant problem. Either the infant is sleeping too much or is awake for longer periods of time.	
Grading	Normal sleep patterns Occasional disturbance Considerable disturbance Constant problems	

1.7.7	Displays positive affect most of the time	Age: 1 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Note the infant's affect.	
Response	The grading is done according to the degree of negative affect displayed during the assessment. Positive affect comprises of smiling, laughing, sound making that is perceived as the expression of excitement, happiness or pleasure. Negative affect includes fussing, pouting, whining, crying, vocal or physical expressions of anger.	
Grading	Displays positive affect Sometimes negative Mostly negative Constantly negative	

1.7.8	Displays normal periods of quietness	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	This item tests the child's quietness. Few children are so quiet that they are very unresponsive.	
Response	The infant is quiet, responsive, not restless.	
Grading	Displays normal periods of quietness Placid/Quiet Unusually Quiet Extremely Quiet	

1.7.9	Displays responsiveness to surroundings	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Observe if infant engages in visual, auditory, oral, or physical exploration. For example, trying to touch or hold objects.	
Response	Degree of responsiveness is noted. A curiosity towards new stimuli within the environment is normal.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Infrequent Never	

1.7.10	Good eye contact	Age: 3 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Note the frequency of eye contact the infant makes with the examiner.	
Response	The infant should be making eye contact with persons interacting with them.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Infrequent Never	

1.7.11	Good attention to tasks	Age: 6 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Observe the infant's focused attention and concentration towards a particular activity in the assessment. Some infants might have attention deficits or attention deficit / hyperactivity disorders that might express themselves at an early age.	
Response	The infant displays good attention to tasks during the assessment.	
Grading	Present Most of the time Poor attention but not hyperactive Poor attention and hyperactive	

1.8 Seizure Item

1.8.4	Seizures (provoked or unprovoked)	Age: 6 - 11 months
Materials	None	
Instructions	Ask caregiver or check medical records to determine whether infant has ever experienced a seizure. Seizures are manifestations of neuronal injury due to excessive electrical activity in the brain. Any disturbance in the brain may cause seizures, which may be single or repetitive, and involves a sudden change in behaviour.	
Response	Consider typical if the child has not had a provoked or unprovoked seizure.	
Grading	No seizures (provoked or unprovoked) One or more than one typical febrile fit in the past year One or more than one unprovoked seizure/atypical febrile fit in past year More than one unprovoked seizure/atypical febrile fit in the past week	